

Date: March 4, 2025

This morning, the cup slipped from my hand while I was making coffee. Just a little spill, nothing major—but for some reason, it really got under my skin. Lately, I've been reacting too strongly to small things. I don't know why. Maybe I'm always expecting something to explode. And when it doesn't... I feel like something's missing.

Cihan showed up early again today. He had that same overly deliberate politeness he always does – just a bit too loud, just a bit too eager. It's like he's constantly trying to be noticed, but isn't quite sure by whom. Maybe he's still trying to prove something to himself. Or maybe to someone who stopped listening a long time ago. He walked past me and muttered something under his breath that sounded like a quote he hoped I'd ask about. I didn't. I didn't even look up. I didn't need to. People like him announce themselves without realizing it.

I played old recordings on the broadcast today. It was part of a program I did a while back, but not many people listened back then. I wanted to present it as if it were new. Sometimes, telling the same thing twice makes more of an impact the second time.

In the afternoon, I found an old voice recorder tucked behind a cabinet. The battery was dead. I didn't try to turn it on. But as I held it in my hand, my mind transformed it into another device—the one I once thought was a toy when I was a kid. My father's recorder.

I remembered trying to eavesdrop on him. That booming voice, those sharp intonations... It always sounded like advice, but from above—never beside you. Even in his own house, there was no space to breathe. Whenever he stood near me, there was a weight on my shoulders. Sometimes, that weight still lingers—in the tone of a word, in the echo of a breath I hear at night.

People don't just grow taller as they age. Some walls inside them grow too. I don't want to lay new bricks on top of mine. But sometimes, you have no choice.

I didn't plan to write tonight. But when I don't, my mind hums like an engine left on. These words help quiet it down, even if just a little.

– 0